

Lenovo Y410 Y So Plain Looking?

The Y series from Lenovo is touted as the *home entertainment* series—the good speakers and a few additional multimedia buttons are a step in the right direction; the plain décor isn't! The Y410 is a good-looking notebook overall, though—the outer body

panels have a quality finish, and this 14.1-inch unit feels sturdy.

The glossy, 1280 x 800 display is clear, crisp and vibrant, with good contrast ratio. The keypad offers good feedback, but it's a little squishy. The shortcut keys are well-laid-out, and you'll have no issues with using the nifty little add-on keys like the volume adjustment, mute, or even the "Novo" key,

which switches between power modes to optimise battery or performance. There is a neat array of multimedia keys that allows you to listen to music without logging in to Windows (after inserting an audio CD).

The Y410 is available in configurations including a speedy Core 2 Duo T7100 (1.8 GHz) and an NVIDIA GeForce 8400M GS with 128 MB of video RAM.

The one we received had a Core 2 Duo T5450 and Intel's GMA 950 graphics solution, which is good enough for most multimedia work, including HD movie playback; just don't expect to game without a graphics card.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

With an overall PC Mark 2005 score of 3251, a 3D Mark 2005 score of 673 and a SiSoft Sandra 2007 drive Index of 39 MBps, the Y410 doesn't really excite as a "high-end" product—at Rs 38,500, it makes sense as an excellent value solution. It's got loads of pre-installed software; we'd have liked to see Windows Vista Home Premium instead of Basic, though. Whether you're looking at a multimedia notebook, or something to use in college or in office—the Y410 has both your needs and your wallet covered.

Specifications

Core 2 Duo T5250; 1 GB RAM; Graphics: Intel GMA 950; 1280 x 800; 14.1 inches; 160 GB HDD, 5400 rpm; Weight: 2.4 kg

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Price: Rs 38,500

Buffalo MiniStation TurboUSB 80 GB Portability With God Speed

The Buffalo MiniStation TurboUSB 80 GB portable hard drive is in a new class of high-performance external hard drives featuring the TurboUSB function that claims to increase speed. It's a laptop SATA hard drive housed in a tough black plastic casing surrounded by cushioning material that absorbs shock. One of its major drawbacks is that it requires an extra USB cable for power.

TurboUSB dramatically increases the drive's speed; by default, this is disabled, but you can enable it using the accompanying software. It took 56 seconds to write 1 GB of assorted files to the drive in the normal mode; it could

achieve the same in TurboUSB mode in just 43 seconds flat—an increase of 23 per cent! TurboUSB isn't a drive "mode" as such—it's a software implementation, so you need to install the utility and enable this feature on any PC that you wish to use this drive with, to get the extra performance.

The bundled SecureLockWare software uses the powerful AES encryption algorithm to safeguard your data from prying eyes. It can not only

encrypt files and folders, but also has an option that lets you encrypt the entire drive, making it virtually impossible to access the contents without entering the password. Memeo Backup is yet another useful tool that comes with the drive—it lets you take automatic and manual backups of your data on the drive.

The Buffalo MiniStation TurboUSB 80 GB impresses with its performance, costs Rs 3,960, and comes with a two-year warranty. For just a little more, you can get a portable drive with twice that capacity and a year more of warranty—that's



what stops us from recommending this drive.

Specifications

80 GB 5400 rpm SATA; Interface: USB 2.0 High-speed; Dimensions: 12.7 (W) x 2 (D) x 8.4 (H) cm; Weight: 190 gm

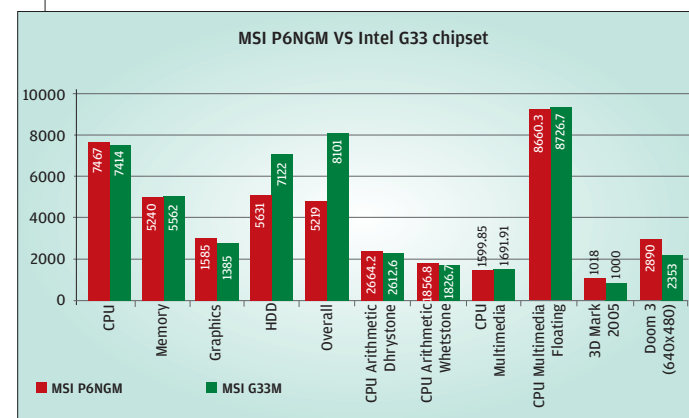
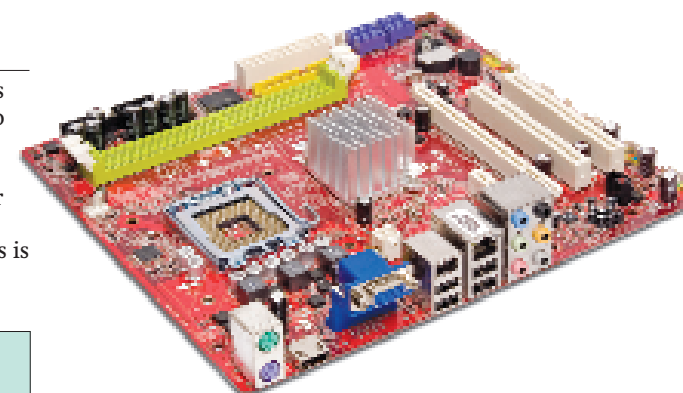
Contact: **Advent Infotech Pvt Ltd**
Phone: +91-011-41436751
E-mail: anjan@adventelectronics.com
Web site: www.buffalo-asia.com
Price: Rs 3,960

RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

MSI P6NGM Another HTPC Candidate!

Based on NVIDIA's new MCP 73 platform, the P6NGM is a mid-sized PCB. It supports all Core 2 Duo and Core 2 Quad processors; there are 2 PCI slots, 1 PCIe x16 slot for a discrete card, 2 memory slots, and 4 SATA

ports. The P6NGM supports 1333 MHz FSB (officially) so all Penryn dual- and quad-cores should work fine. A 4-pin CPU power connector defies the new 8-pin standard. The onboard graphics is a GeForce 7050 solution—



D-Sub and HDMI connects have been provided as well.

Specifications

NVIDIA MCP 73 chipset; 1 x16 PCIe, 2 x PCI, 1 x PCI X1 slots; 4 x SATA 2.0, 1 x IDE ports, 1 x D-Sub, 1 x HDMI connect

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Ease of Use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

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E-mail: sanyam@msi-india.com
Web site: www.msi-india.com
Price: Rs 8,500

Genius iTempo 800CD A Costly iPod Dock That Fails to Impress

Genius' iTempo 800CD is a product aimed at iPod users, but it does a lot more than just playing music from your 'pod. There is an SD / MMC slot and space for a USB drive as well, so you don't have to own an iPod to use this. Dump some music on your USB drive or pop in a CD, plug it in, and you're ready to go. It's also an AM / FM radio receiver. The slot-loading optical disc reader only reads CDs, though. The drive has no foam padding to prevent dust from getting into the player, and the mechanism that pulls the disc in is a little crude.

For a product that will end up in people's living rooms, the iTempo is not exactly attractive. The body is heavy and sturdy, but has a plasticky feel. The blue backlit screen on the front looks decent, and the panel surrounding it has a glossy

finish. The quality of buttons and volume dial is poor, and the mesh on the speakers looks cheap.

The remote control has the same set of buttons as on the player, and it resembles remotes that came with some early CD ROM drive kits—thin, light and very clunky buttons.

Sound quality isn't impressive. The speakers are a total of 20 W RMS, which isn't a lot, but



adequate for the size. You can use the auxiliary out to connect to better speakers. There are a few equaliser settings, and the only manual changes you can make are to the amount of bass and treble. The menus and the working of the iTempo 800CD need some time getting used to.

We aren't impressed by this product, especially since it retails at Rs 13,500. It's an average performer and doesn't make a great

fashion accessory for your living room either.

Specifications

2.1 Speakers, 20W RMS, AM / FM Radio Tuner, SD/MMC and USB supported, Antenna and remote control supplied.

RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

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Phone: 011-41580611
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Web site: www.geniusnet.com
Price: Rs 13,500